

CITY CHURCH LUFKIN

IMPRESSIONS TEAM GUIDEBOOK

Your guide to serving on the front lines of ministry at **City Church Lufkin**

GREETERS | USHERS | COFFEE BAR | PARKING | CONNECTIONS

SECTION 01

01

WELCOME TO THE TEAM

The front door of City Church starts with you.



IMPRESSIONS • WELCOME

A LETTER TO OUR TEAM

To our Impressions Team,

Thank you. What you do is some of the most important ministry we have.

Before anyone hears a song or a single word of the message, they experience you. They feel the warmth of your smile, the ease of your welcome, and the genuineness of your care. In many ways, you are preaching before the preacher ever opens his mouth.

Research tells us that most people decide whether they'll return to a church within the first ten minutes of their visit — before they ever sit down. That window belongs to you. That's not pressure; it's an extraordinary privilege. You get to set the tone for someone's entire encounter with God.

People walk through our doors carrying things we can't see. Fear. Shame. Skepticism. Grief. Hope. And the very first thing they encounter is you — your energy, your presence, your welcome. When people feel seen before they feel spoken to, their hearts open. And when their hearts are open, they can hear from God.

That's not a small thing. That's everything.

WELCOME TO THE IMPRESSIONS TEAM.

You are not just a volunteer — you are a **minister**.

Eric & Christy Barton

Lead Pastors, City Church Lufkin

SECTION 02

02

MISSION & VALUES

Why we do what we do.



SECTION 02 • MISSION

OUR MISSION

WE EXIST TO...

See people lead full lives in Christ. — John 10:10

As a member of the Impressions Team, you are the first expression of this mission. Before anyone hears teaching or enters worship, they experience you. What you do directly determines whether someone's heart is open or closed to everything that follows.

MISSION PILLARS

City Church defines "full life in Christ" through four pillars. Your role as an Impressions volunteer touches every single one:

HOPE

You may be the first person someone encounters after driving 45 minutes just to try church one more time. Your welcome is their first taste of hope.

COMMUNITY

A warm smile and a genuine conversation are the beginning of community. Nobody joins a church they feel invisible in.

PURPOSE

When people feel welcomed and valued, they begin to believe they might belong here — and that belonging opens the door to discovering purpose.

IMPACT

You are the impact. You are the difference between someone coming back and never returning.



SECTION 02 • CITY CHURCH VALUES

CHURCH VALUES

These values are the culture of City Church. They shape every ministry, every team, and every Sunday — including yours.

LOVE IS OUR MOTIVE

Everything we do flows from love — love for God and love for people. — 1 Cor 16:14

GOD'S PRESENCE IS OUR PASSION

We don't just attend church — we passionately pursue the presence of God. — Psalm 16:11

JOY IS OUR EXPRESSION

We carry the joy of the Lord into everything we do. — Nehemiah 8:10

COMMUNITY IS OUR COMMITMENT

We grow, serve, and thrive through real relationships with one another. — 1 Cor 12:27

SERVING IS OUR PRIVILEGE

We follow Jesus' example by serving with humility and love. We don't have to — we get to. — Mark 10:45

EXCELLENCE IS OUR WORSHIP

We give our best in every detail — not for perfection's sake, but as an act of honor and worship to God. — Colossians 3:23

GENEROSITY IS OUR WAY

We live open-handed with our time, resources, and hearts. — 2 Cor 9:11



SECTION 02 • TEAM VALUES

TEAM VALUES

These values describe who we are as a team — how we treat each other, lead ourselves, and show up every week.

I AM A SERVANT LEADER

I lead by serving. I look for ways to make the team and the people around me better.

I CHOOSE TO SEE THE BEST

I believe the best about my team, my leaders, and the guests we serve. Cynicism has no place here.

I AM COMMITTED TO GROWTH

I am not done. I stay hungry to learn, improve, and develop as a leader and as a person.

I TAKE OWNERSHIP

I don't wait to be told. I see what needs to be done and I do it — with excellence and a good attitude.

I WILL COMMUNICATE

I keep the team informed. I don't go dark. I speak up early when something isn't working.

I HELP OTHERS TAKE STEPS

My job isn't just to do my role — it's to help the people around me grow and move forward.

SECTION 03

03

THE POWER OF FIRST IMPRESSIONS

You are preaching before the preacher opens his mouth.



SECTION 03 • WHY IT MATTERS

THE 10-MINUTE WINDOW

Surveys, statistics, and decades of research say the same thing: most people decide whether they will return to a church within the first ten minutes of their first visit. That decision is made long before the sermon, long before the offering, often before they've even found a seat.

10 MINUTES

Most guests have already decided whether they're coming back — before the message begins.

As they drive onto the campus, walk through the doors, find the coffee bar, and settle into their seats — people form powerful impressions. They feel whether they are welcome. They feel whether they belong. And they feel it through you.

A GOD EXPERIENCE BEGINS WITH A GOOD EXPERIENCE

When people enter a place feeling welcomed and genuinely cared for, their hearts are more open to hearing from God. When they feel confused, invisible, or unwelcome — even if it's subtle — they become guarded. And guarded hearts are harder to reach.

This isn't manipulation. It's hospitality. It's the biblical principle that love opens doors. Your kindness isn't just good customer service — it's creating the conditions for someone to encounter Jesus.



SECTION 03 • OUR OBJECTIVE

EXCEED EXPECTATIONS

People walk into a church building with all kinds of preconceived notions about what church is like. Our goal — your goal — is to shatter every one of those assumptions with warmth, competence, and genuine care.

OUR TEAM OBJECTIVE

Create an environment where people can hear from God and move from where they are to where God wants them to be.

Here's what that looks like practically:

PREPARE BEFORE THEY ARRIVE

Think about the steps you'd take if an important guest were coming to your home for dinner. You wouldn't leave laundry on the couch. You'd be ready. Know the building. Know the events. Know the answers — before anyone asks.

SEE THROUGH A GUEST'S EYES

What's obvious to you isn't obvious to someone who has never been here. Where are the bathrooms? Where are the kids? Where do we go? Anticipate questions and answer them before they're asked.

BE PERSONAL, NOT POSITIONAL

Good signage helps — but you're better than a sign. You can escort, encourage, converse, and connect. Personal attention always beats directions on a wall.

BRING THE ENERGY

Excitement is contagious. If you're genuinely glad to be here, people will feel it. If you're going through the motions, they'll feel that too.



SECTION 03 • MOTIVATION

WHY WE BRING THE EXCITEMENT

High energy isn't a performance — it's a response to what's actually true. Here's what you know every single Sunday that most of the world doesn't:

- Jesus is alive. Not historically. Now. We worship a God who conquered death and is actively ruling and reigning. That's worth showing up for.
- We are redeemed. We were lost — and now we're found. Amazing grace is not a cliché; it's our actual story. Carry it like it matters.
- Every weekend is someone's first time. A husband who hasn't been to church in ten years. A single mom looking for hope. A teenager who came because a friend finally asked. They are here. They are looking. And what they see first is you.
- People are meeting Jesus here. City Church is a place where real life change happens every single week. The angels celebrate when one person comes to faith. You get to be part of that.
- The local church is God's Plan A. There is no Plan B. What we're doing here matters more than anything else happening in Lufkin this weekend. Serve like it.

Excitement is contagious. If you believe what you say you believe, let it show. **Your energy today may be someone's reason to come back.**

SECTION 04

04

HOW WE SHOW UP

Excellence is an act of worship.



SECTION 04 • STANDARDS

TEAM STANDARDS

Because what we do is so important, we hold a high standard for how we show up. These are expectations for every Impressions Team member, every role, every week.

BEFORE THE SERVICE

- Arrive 30 minutes before service. Your position needs you before the first guest arrives.
- Check in with your Team Lead and participate in the pre-service Huddle. This is where vision is cast, information is shared, and the team prays together.
- Be in position 25 minutes before service begins — fully ready, not still getting coffee.
- Know what's happening this weekend: special events, new series, campus updates. Be prepared to answer questions.

DURING THE SERVICE

- Refrain from eating, drinking, or using your phone while serving.
- Stay focused on your assignment — don't get pulled into extended conversations with friends while guests go ungreeted.
- Stay in position for at least 15 minutes after the service starts; late arrivals still need your welcome.
- When the sermon begins, take a seat on the aisle — be a participant, not a spectator in the back.
- Do not move during the response time or prayer. Be present for the most important moment of the service.
- At the end of service, get back in position in time to thank people as they leave.

COMMUNICATION

- Manage your schedule through Planning Center. Respond to scheduling requests promptly.
- If you cannot serve on a scheduled day, communicate with your Team Lead as early as possible and try to find a replacement.
- Never just no-show. If you can't make it, the team needs to know — your position needs to be covered.

DRESS & PERSONAL PRESENTATION

Dress casual and appropriate — match the people we're reaching. When in doubt, ask your Team Lead.

- Avoid anything revealing, extreme, or that could distract from the guest experience.
- Practice good personal hygiene. Use deodorant. A mint is always a good idea.
- Wear your name badge/lanyard every time you serve. It makes you approachable and identifies you to guests and first-timers.
- Parking Team: Wear your City Church shirt and pick up a vest at the Huddle — high visibility is essential.

ILLNESS

If you are sick, have a cold, or think you may be getting sick — please do not serve. Notify your Team Lead, try to find a replacement, and take care of yourself. We appreciate you protecting the team and our guests.

SECTION 05

05

ROLE DESCRIPTIONS

Every role. Every team. Every person.



SECTION 05 • LEADERSHIP

IMPRESSIONS TEAM LEAD

IMPRESSIONS TEAM LEAD Volunteer

REPORTS TO *Operations Director*

The Impressions Team Lead oversees all front-door volunteers — greeters, ushers, the connections table, coffee team, and parking — ensuring every person who walks in feels immediately welcomed.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Lead and coordinate all Impressions volunteers before and during services.
- Cast the vision for first impressions and ensure every team member understands the why behind their role.
- Run the pre-service Huddle: vision, information, prayer.
- Recruit, train, and ensure every Impressions position is covered every Sunday.
- Be the first point of contact for any guest experience issue or need that arises during the service.

THE WIN *Every guest's first experience at City Church is warm, welcoming, and memorable. Nobody slips through unnoticed.*



SECTION 05 • GREETERS

GREETERS

Greeters are the first face of City Church — serving at entrances, doors, and key decision points throughout the building. Your greeting communicates one message above everything else: You belong here.

GREETER — FRONT DOOR / LOBBY / OUTSIDE Volunteer

REPORTS TO *Impressions Team Lead*

Greeters welcome every person arriving at City Church with a smile, genuine warmth, and the message: you belong here.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Be in position before service begins, ready to welcome every person who arrives.
- Greet guests and regulars with warmth, eye contact, and authentic friendliness — not a scripted performance.
- Help first-time guests find what they need: restrooms, Kid City, coffee, seating.
- Give guests a handout at the sanctuary door and say, "Welcome to City Church."
- Proactively direct parents with children to the Kid City environments. Introduce them to a Kid City team member and return to your post.
- Stay in position for at least 15 minutes after the service begins; many guests arrive late.
- As people leave, thank them and say, "Have a great week."

THE WIN *Every person who walks through the door feels genuinely welcomed — not just handed a program, but actually seen and treated like family.*

DIRECTING FAMILIES TO KID CITY — THREE STEPS

1. AWARENESS — Introduce yourself to parents AND kids. Ask: "Are you aware we have environments specifically designed for kids?" 2. TOUR — "I'd love to show you the Kid City area — it'll only take a couple of minutes. Right this way." 3. CONNECT — Introduce the family to a Kid City worker, then return to your post.



SECTION 05 • USHERS

USHERS

While greeters serve at the entrances, ushers serve inside the service room — helping seat people, facilitating the offering, and managing the auditorium experience so everyone can fully engage in worship.

USHER Volunteer

REPORTS TO *Impressions Team Lead*

Ushers serve the congregation during the service — seating people, facilitating the offering, and managing the auditorium experience with care and professionalism.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Be in position and ready 25 minutes before service begins. Check in your children and handle personal needs before then.
- Help guests find their seats proactively — take steps toward people who look lost, not just waiting to be asked.
- Guide people toward the front and middle, filling center seats first. Be kind and firm.
- Stay in position until the sermon begins, then take a seat on the aisle.
- Facilitate the offering, communion, and any in-service needs with excellence.
- Manage distractions during the service. Disruptive situations need to be handled with care but clarity — the experience of the many matters.
- Return to position at the end of service — but not during the response time or prayer.

THE WIN *The auditorium runs smoothly. People are comfortable, the offering flows naturally, and anyone who needs help can always find it.*



SECTION 05 • COFFEE BAR

COFFEE BAR

The Coffee Bar is one of City Church's most distinctive features — a relaxed, welcoming space where people can breathe, connect, and prepare their hearts before the service. Serving free coffee is one of the most disarming, welcoming things we do. Don't underestimate it.

COFFEE BAR **Volunteer**

REPORTS TO *Impressions Team Lead*

Coffee Bar volunteers welcome guests and regulars to City Church, creating a warm, relaxed atmosphere where people feel at home before the service begins.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Arrive 30 minutes before service and begin setup immediately — the bar opens 20 minutes prior to every service.
- Make coffee, keep air pots filled, and maintain a clean, organized serving area throughout.
- Serve with a smile and genuine friendliness — you're not just pouring coffee, you're creating a moment.
- Keep inventory and inform the Team Lead of items that need restocking.
- Stay at the bar until the service starts, then participate in the service — don't stand in the back.
- Return to the bar at the end of service to serve people again during connection time.

THE WIN *Guests walk in and immediately feel the difference. The Coffee Bar sets a tone of generosity and warmth that stays with people all service long.*



SECTION 05 • PARKING TEAM

PARKING TEAM

The guest experience begins before they ever get out of the car. The Parking Team sets the tone for the entire morning — your wave, your smile, and your clear direction communicate in those first seconds: this is a place that has it together and is glad you're here.

PARKING TEAM Volunteer

REPORTS TO *Impressions Team Lead*

Parking Team volunteers create first impressions by directing traffic and welcoming people to City Church before they ever walk through the door.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Wear your City Church shirt and pick up a vest at the pre-service Huddle — visibility is critical.
- Be in position 25 minutes before service begins.
- Wave first, then direct. As cars approach, wave to say hello — then clearly point them where to go. Always smile.
- Communicate with your team: let them know if spaces are filling up, if someone looks confused, or if traffic flow needs adjusting.
- Stay in position until at least 10 minutes after the service starts — many people arrive late.
- When attending the service, take a seat on the aisle. Return to position when service ends.

THE WIN *Guests pull in and immediately feel expected and welcomed. Traffic flows. Nobody is confused. And the whole morning starts on the right foot — before anyone walks through the door.*



SECTION 05 • CONNECTIONS TABLE

CONNECTIONS TABLE

The Connections Table is where a good experience becomes a next step. It's where a first-time guest goes from curious visitor to someone with a real connection to City Church. This role requires relational skill, knowledge of our Next Steps pathway, and a genuine love for people.

CONNECTIONS TABLE **Volunteer**

REPORTS TO *Impressions Team Lead*

Connections Table volunteers are the go-to resource for first-time guests and anyone exploring their next step — helping people find their place at City Church.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Staff the connections table before and after services — be ready before guests arrive, not scrambling to set up.
- Know City Church's Next Steps pathway and be able to explain it clearly to a brand-new guest.
- Connect interested guests with the right person or resource: Life Groups, serve teams, counseling, follow-up.
- Be warm, curious, and unhurried — take as long as people need. This conversation matters more than staying on schedule.
- Collect and pass along guest contact information and follow-up requests to the appropriate leader.

THE WIN *Every first-time guest who visits the connections table leaves with a clear next step and a personal connection to someone at City Church.*

YOU ARE NOT JUST A VOLUNTEER.

You are the first chapter of someone's story at City Church.

citychurchlufkin.com